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Sun Prairie considers Axon to replace Flock Safety license plate readers

Lauryn Abozeid
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SUN PRAIRIE, Wis. (WKOW) -- Sun Prairie will not renew its contract with Flock Safety on Dec. 31 and is considering Axon as a potential replacement for its license plate reader cameras.

Police Chief Kevin Warych says the decision isn't because Sun Prairie has experienced problems with Flock. Instead, his department wants to consolidate its technology, as it already uses Axon for body cameras and Tasers. The move also addresses concerns about privacy, data retention and who can access the information.

"The license plate reader technology is very much the same. There is nothing, as far as when I mean by that, is a picture of a license plate at that point in time," Warych said. "No matter what vendor you choose, that's what they do."

The difference will come in how Sun Prairie handles the data. Warych says the city will change how long information is kept and which law enforcement agencies can access it.

"We're going to start from scratch, and we're going to work our way with what we think is right," Warych said.

But David Bendit, who has lived in Sun Prairie for seven years, says switching companies doesn't address concerns about an invasion of public privacy.

"Three cameras were added specifically around Woodman's and the dialysis center over there, which means anyone going to that place cannot get there by vehicle without being tracked by these cameras," Bendit said.

He questions whether the city needs the cameras at all.

"Policing existed long before it," Bendit said.

Warych says the technology can help police develop leads faster and that he wants to be open and transparent about the new technology.

Community members will also have a chance to weigh in. A public hearing is set for Oct. 7.

Lauryn Abozeid

Lauryn Abozeid joined the 27 News team in June 2025 as a Multimedia Journalist and Digital Content Producer. A proud graduate of the University of Arizona, she earned her Bachelor of Arts in Journalism with a minor in Communications.

During her time at Arizona, Lauryn was actively involved in student media through UATV3, where she covered sideline reporting for all Arizona sports and reported on a wide range of community-focused stories. She also gained valuable experience interning at Tucson Spotlight, where she covered city council meetings and reported on key local issues.

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